

Range Command Card

CHATGPT EDITION

Stop gates, roles, and the shot cycle

SUPERVISED-ONLY PROJECT

One named, sober adult controls the launcher, fuel, ignition, commands, misfires, and cease-fire. Minors do not fuel, ignite, clear a misfire, or handle a loaded launcher. This set is educational guidance, not a certification of any component or assembly.

No gate, no shot

1. Legality and landowner/site permission confirmed for this location.
2. Walked, empty range; positive earthen backstop; no roads, buildings, trails, animals, property boundary, or unseen ground in the line of fire.
3. Pressure-marked solid-wall pipe and pressure fittings only: no DWV, cellular/foam core, mixed system, damage, whitening, cracks, or UV embrittlement. A pressure mark is a screen, not combustion approval.
4. Solvent joints cured at least 48 hours, and longer whenever the actual cement label/chart, temperature, humidity, diameter, or service demands it.
5. No pneumatic conversion, compressed air, oxygen enrichment, liquid accelerant, improvised fuel transfer, or firing in cold, fire-risk, or prohibited conditions.
6. Every person behind the marked line with impact-rated side-protection eyewear and correctly fitted earplugs *plus* earmuffs.

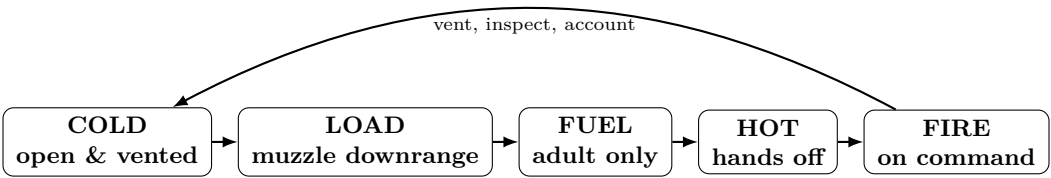
Four roles, one authority

Adult lead	Owns the launcher, fuel and igniter; calls every state change; may stop the session without debate.
Range watcher	Watches the entire downrange area and backstop; says “clear” only after a fresh scan; calls “CEASE FIRE” on any change.
Recorder	Logs condition, shot number and observation from behind the line. No approach until released by the adult lead.
Everyone	Eyes and double hearing protection on; stays behind the line; repeats a cease-fire call so it cannot be missed.

Range-opening proof

Gate	Evidence spoken and recorded	Initial
Authority and legality	Site permission and current local restriction checked: _____	
Walked containment	Entire cone walked; positive earth backstop identified; roads, paths, structures, people, animals absent	
Conditions	Wind and fire conditions stable; no aircraft concern; extinguisher placed at line	
People and PPE	Roles named; attendance counted; impact eye protection, earplugs and earmuffs fitted	
Launcher evidence	Build acceptance signed; cold inspection passed; no damage, repair, loose part, or altered witness line	

States, spoken aloud



State proof — recorder repeats before each transition	
COLD	Breech open and vented; projectile accounted for; adult says “cold.”
LOAD	Range watcher has freshly called clear; muzzle never left downrange.
FUEL	Adult alone controls fuel; no prior dose remains; everyone stays back.
HOT	Hands off; named adult at control; watcher repeats “clear.”
FIRE	Adult calls the shot; no one moves until the adult returns the system to COLD by venting, accounting, and inspecting.

MISFIRE BRANCH

Do not retry, add fuel, open, move, peer into, or approach. Adult lead calls “MISFIRE—HOLD.” Keep the muzzle downrange and every person behind the line for a full **60 seconds**. Then the adult vents from the breech end while remaining out of the muzzle line. A second anomaly ends the session.

Anomaly record — complete before deciding whether the session ends

Time / shot ID _____ State when noticed _____

Exact sound, motion, surface change, spill, or range change: _____

60-second hold start / finish _____ Adult vented []

Disposition: [] session ended [] assembly retired [] cold inspection documented

Stop means stop

Stop immediately for a person, vehicle, animal, aircraft concern, shifting wind/fire condition, lost projectile, unexpected sound, weak/odd discharge, damaged or dropped launcher, loose fitting, fuel spill, PPE failure, or any uncertainty. Unload and vent before discussion. Cracked, crazed, whitened, deformed, badly UV-weathered, or heat-damaged PVC is retired, not repaired.



Range before mechanism. The line holds every person behind the launcher; the walked ground stays empty; the earthen backstop, not a calculated landing point, closes the range.

Why the range is larger than the equation

The classroom trajectory assumes no air drag and a known launch state. A real potato is irregular, draggy, variable, and capable of fragmenting. A calculation is for learning; a walked empty range and positive earth backstop are for safety. Never use a predicted landing point as a boundary.

Session-closing acceptance

1. Adult returns the mechanism to COLD, vents it, and physically separates fuel and ignition control from the launcher.
2. Recorder accounts for every projectile and records every anomaly, including “weak” or merely unusual events.
3. Adult inspects for new whitening, cracks, heat, movement, or impact. Any change means retirement, not another confirming shot.
4. Range watcher declares the ground safe to enter; equipment and residue are recovered; fire watch continues until the site is cold.

Shots attempted _____ Projectiles accounted for _____ Anomalies attached []
Adult close-out signature _____ Time site released _____

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